

IVERPASTE 18.7MG/G ORAL PASTE

Description and Composition

IVERPASTE 18.7MG/G ORAL PASTE is a white to off-white paste. Each gram contains 18.7mg of Ivermectin as its active ingredient.

Pharmacodynamics

Ivermectin is a macrocyclic lactone derivative and acts by inhibiting nerve impulses. It binds selectively and with high affinity to glutamate-gated chloride ion channels which occur in invertebrate nerve and muscle cells. This leads to an increase in the permeability of the cell membrane to chloride ions with hyperpolarization of the nerve or muscle cell, resulting in paralysis and death of the relevant parasites. Compounds of this class may also interact with other ligand-gated chloride channels, such as those gated by the neurotransmitter gamma-aminobutyric acid (GABA). The margin of safety for compounds of this class is attributable to the fact that mammals do not have glutamate-gated chloride channels. The macrocyclic lactones have a low affinity for other mammalian ligand-gated chloride channels and they do not readily cross the blood-brain barrier.

Pharmacokinetics

After oral administration of the recommended doses to horses, the following parameters were observed: C_{max} of 48.79 ng/ml, T_{max} of 5.5 hours, elimination half-life of 61 hours. Ivermectin is eliminated primarily via the faeces.

Indication

Roundworms in the stomach and intestines.

Large strongyles: *Strongylus vulgaris* (adults and 4th larval [arterial] stages), *Strongylus edentatus* (adults and 4th larval [tissue] stages), and *Strongylus equinus* (adults). Small Strongyles, adults: *Cyathostomum* spp., *Cylicocyclus* spp., *Cylicodontophorus* spp., *Cylicostephanus* spp. and *Gyalocephalus* spp.. Hairworms: *Trichostrongylus axei* (adults). Pinworms: *Oxyuris equi* (adult and immatures). Ascarids: *Parascaris equorum* (adults). Intestinal threadworms: *Strongyloides westeri* (adults). Large-mouth stomach worms: *Habronema muscae* (adults). Neck threadworms: *Onchocerca* spp. (microfilariae). Lungworms: *Dictyocaulus arnfieldi* (adult and immatures). Stomach bots: *Gasterophilus* spp. (oral and gastric larval stages).

Recommended Dose

A single administration of 200µg Ivermectin per kg of body weight. Each syringe division mark plunger delivers enough paste to treat 100kg of body weight (which corresponds to 1.07g of product and 20mg of Ivermectin).

The syringe containing 6.42g of paste delivers sufficient paste to treat 600kg of body weight at the recommended dose range. The syringe containing 7.49g of paste delivers sufficient paste to treat 700kg of body weight at the recommended dose range.

Horse weight should be accurately determined for the correct use of the paste. The animal's mouth should be free of food. The syringe must be positioned between the front and back teeth and the paste must be placed on the base of the horse's tongue. Immediately elevate the head of the horse for a few seconds to ensure deglutition. Re-treatment should be done according to the epidemiological situation, but not at less than 30 days interval.

Route of Administration

By oral administration only.

Contraindication

Do not use in dogs or cats as severe adverse reactions may occur.

Do not use in cases of known hypersensitivity to the active substance.

See also section "Withdrawal period".

Warning and Precautions

Special warning for each target species:

Strategies that should be avoided because they might lead to an increased risk of development of resistance to anthelmintic drugs include:

1. Too frequent and repeated use of anthelmintics from the same class, over an extended period of time.
2. Underdosing, which may be due to underestimation of body weight, misadministration of the product or lack of calibration of the dosing device (if any).

Suspected clinical cases of resistance to anthelmintics should be further investigated using appropriate tests. Where the results of the tests(s) strongly suggest resistance to a particular anthelmintic, an anthelmintic belonging to another pharmacological class and having a different mode of action should be used. Resistance to ivermectin has been reported in *Parascaris equorum* in horses. Therefore, the use of this product should be based on local (regional, farm) epidemiological information about susceptibility of nematodes and recommendations on how to limit further selection for resistance to anthelmintics.

Special precautions for use:

Special precautions for use in animals:

Avermectins may not be well tolerated in all non-target species (cases of intolerance with fatal outcome are reported in dogs, especially Collies, Old English Sheepdogs and related breeds or crosses, and also in turtles/tortoises).

As ivermectin is extremely dangerous to fish and aquatic life treated animals should not have direct access to surface water and ditches during treatment.

Parasite resistance to any particular class of anthelmintic may develop following frequent, repeated use of an anthelmintic of that class.

Since ivermectin is highly bound to plasma proteins, special care should be taken in cases of sick animals or in nutritional conditions associated with low plasma protein levels.

As with all anthelmintics, a veterinary surgeon should establish appropriate dosing programs and stock management to achieve adequate parasite control and reduce the likelihood of anthelmintic resistance.

Special precautions to be taken by the person administering the veterinary medicinal product to animals:

Do not eat, drink or smoke while handling the product. Avoid contact with skin and eyes. If accidental skin contact occurs, wash the affected area immediately with soap and water. If accidental eye exposure occurs, flush the eyes immediately with water and, if necessary, get medical attention. Wash hands after use.

Interaction with Other Medicaments

The effects of GABA agonists are increased by ivermectin.

Pregnancy and Lactation

Can be used in pregnant mares.

See also section "Withdrawal period".

Side Effects

Some horses carrying heavy infection of *Onchocerca microfilariae* have experienced reactions with swelling and itching following dosing, assumed to be the result of death of large numbers of microfilariae. These signs resolve within a few days but symptomatic treatment may be advisable.

Symptoms and Treatment of Overdose

Mild transitory signs (slowed pupillary light response and depression) have been seen at a higher dose of 1.8 mg/kg (9 times the recommended dose level). Other signs seen at higher doses include mydriasis, ataxia, tremors, stupor, coma and death. The less severe signs have been transitory. Although no antidote has been identified, symptomatic therapy may be beneficial.

Storage Condition

Store below 30°C. Protect from light.

Shelf life

3 years. After first opening the container, any product remaining after 24 hours should be discarded.

Withdrawal Period

Meat and offal: 30 days.

Do not use in mares producing milk for human consumption.

Packing

6.42g and 7.49g

Revision date: 16.5.2023

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